

词汇: *additives* 添加剂

- 1 Food colouring is difficult to avoid. From bright orange cheesy crisps to **frosted** cakes, and even peanuts and meat, these additives make food more **visually appealing**. But for years, people have been worried about their safety and the long-term effects on our bodies. So, just how bad is food colouring, and what are the alternatives?
- 2 **Synthetic** food dyes, like Red 40 and Yellow 6, have been linked to **hyperactivity** and attention problems in children, particularly those in key stages of brain development. Studies show that even small amounts of these dyes, which are commonly found in **ultra-processed** foods, can affect behaviour. In 2010, the EU began requiring **warning labels** on products containing specific **artificial** colourings associated with hyperactivity in children.
- 3 There are further issues too, such as **allergic reactions**. Yellow 5 has been shown to produce **hives**, itching and symptoms typically associated with **asthma** in some people. It's derived from petroleum and is found in a range of foods, medicine and cosmetics. Red 3 is also problematic – links have been found between the colour and cancer in male rats. This dye is almost completely **banned** in the UK now, and food manufacturers in the USA have been given until 2027 to modify foods that currently use it in their recipe.
- 4 So, what can artificial colours be replaced with? There are natural alternatives like **beetroot**, **turmeric**, **paprika** and **spirulina**. Companies such as Fermentalg based in France are developing natural colourings from **microalgae**, such as *Galdieria sulphuraria*, which produces a bright blue **pigment**. Products using this colour are expected to be on shop shelves in the USA soon, alongside other natural blue dyes like butterfly pea **extract** and gardenia blue, which have all recently been approved by the Food and Drug Administration in the US. However, replacing synthetic dyes can be challenging because of stability, cost, and colour intensity. Natural dyes tend to be less **vivid** and have shorter **shelf lives**.
- 5 So, it's hard to avoid, but for your health do what you can to minimise unnecessary artificial colours in what you eat, and stick to natural alternatives instead.

测验与练习

一、为本文选择总结句。

1. Which statement best summarises the article?
 - a. All food colouring is generally harmful.
 - b. Natural alternatives are replacing artificial food dyes.
 - c. Dyes are essential for making food look appetising.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. The safety of food dyes has recently become a worry for people.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
2. What products are warning labels required to be on in the EU?
 - a. Foods that are essential for children's brain development
 - b. Ultra-processed foods
 - c. Foods containing colours associated with hyperactivity in children
3. The dye Red 3...
 - a. can produce allergic reactions, including hives.
 - b. is banned in the UK.
 - c. is being removed from food products in the USA.
4. What does 'this colour' refer to in the following sentence? *Products using this colour are expected to be on shop shelves in the USA soon.*
 - a. Microalgae
 - b. Galdieria sulphuraria
 - c. Butterfly pea extract
5. Why can replacing synthetic dyes with natural ones be a challenge?
 - a. Because natural dyes are more vivid in colour and don't last as long
 - b. Because synthetic dyes have more intense colours and longer shelf lives
 - c. Because the cost of synthetic dyes is higher than natural alternatives

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

There are numerous **1)** _____ dyes out there these days, such as **2)** _____ which gives food a yellow colour. A lot of **3)** _____ colours have been given **4)** _____ in the EU due to their associations with **5)** _____ in children and occasionally allergic reactions.

natural	behaviour	hyperactivity
warning labels		turmeric
beetroot		artificial

(答案见词汇表后)

词汇表

frosted	撒了糖霜的
visually appealing	视觉上吸引人的
synthetic	合成的，人造的
hyperactivity	多动亢奋
ultra-processed	超加工的
warning label	警告标签
artificial	人造的
allergic reaction	过敏反应
hives	荨麻疹
asthma	气喘，哮喘
ban	禁止
beetroot	甜菜根
turmeric	姜黄根粉
paprika	红辣椒粉
spirulina	（可食用的）干螺旋藻
microalgae	微藻
pigment	色素
extract	提取物
vivid	鲜艳的
shelf life	保质期

答案

一、为本文选择总结句。

b. Natural alternatives are replacing artificial food dyes. So, *what can **artificial colours** be **replaced with**? There are **natural alternatives** like beetroot, turmeric, paprika and spirulina. Products using this colour are **expected to be on shop shelves** in the USA **soon, alongside other natural blue dyes** like butterfly pea **extract** and gardenia blue, which have **all recently been approved by the Food and Drug Administration** in the US.*

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **b. False.** *But **for years**, people have been worried about their safety and the long-term effects on our body.*

2. **c.** *In 2010, the EU began requiring **warning labels** on products containing specific **artificial colourings associated with hyperactivity** in children.*

3. **c.** *Another problematic colour is **Red 3**, ... and **food manufacturers in the USA** have been given until **2027** to **modify** foods that currently use it in their recipe.*

4. **b.** *Companies ... are developing natural colourings from microalgae, such as **Galdieria sulphuraria** ...Products using **this colour** are expected to be on shop shelves in the USA soon.*

5. **b.** *However, replacing synthetic dyes can be **challenging** because of stability, cost, and colour intensity. **Natural dyes** tend to be **less vivid** and **have shorter shelf lives**.*

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

There are numerous **natural** dyes out there these days, such as **turmeric** which gives food a yellow colour. A lot of **artificial** colours have been given **warning labels** in the EU due to their associations with **hyperactivity** in children and occasionally allergic reactions.